

one filter simply isn't enough to do justice to the picture, you can use this neat trick.

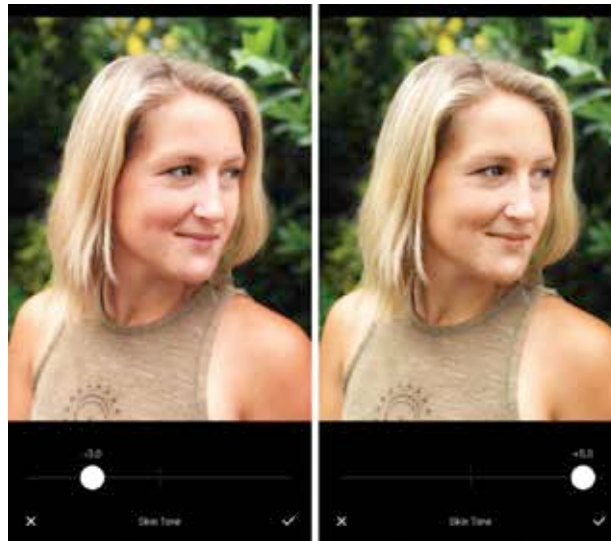
First, apply a filter to your chosen picture on VSCO, adjust the intensity to your liking and save the image to the Gallery. Once you have done so, you will need to import the saved picture back to VSCO and apply a second filter. Be wary though, going overboard with multiple presets can effectively ruin a picture and end up looking like a giant mess.



NAIL THE SKIN TONE IN PORTRAITS

It is extremely crucial to get the skin tone of the subject right when shooting portraits. Lighting and other conditions can cause the skin tone to sometimes appear quite different from real life. Filters used in VSCO or any other editing app can also do a number on skin tones. To resolve this, in VSCO, presets G4 to G9 are curated specifically for portraits. You could also try your luck with the E-series of filters.

However, if none of the presets seem to work to get your desired skin tone, you should check out the built-in Skin Tone slider which works as a way to preserve original skin tones. To access this tool, click on the second icon from the left on the toolbar on the bottom of the screen and scroll sideways until you find the Skin Tone slider. Once you find it, you can drag the slider until you reach the appropriate skin tone. Moving the slider to the left can eliminate green tones, which is perfect if your subject looks sickly, and moving it to the right will remove red tones, which works to remove splotches, acne or a flushed look.



Skin Tone slider on VSCO



SEPARATE EXPOSURE AND FOCUS

In addition to being a capable photo editor, VSCO also gives you access to a few camera tools which aren't usually present on default smartphone camera apps. One of these is the ability to separate the focus point in the photograph and exposure level. We've definitely faced the problem of inefficient exposure in a picture when we select a particular focus point which renders the rest of the image completely dark.



Separating exposure and focus is possible with the VSCO camera

To combat this, all you need to do is fire up the VSCO camera in the app and point towards your subject. Then, tap on the camera screen with two fingers to separate exposure level and the focus point. Once you've done this, two circles denoting 'focus' and 'exposure' will appear. You can drag these circles to the position you deem fit and then click your photograph. This feature can be exceptionally useful in product photography, and also landscape photography since you can't really control the shadows or the brightness in the latter.

Note: This feature is only available on iOS as of now.



SAVE YOUR FAVOURITE 'RECIPE'

Theming your Instagram feed is one of the most important things you need to accomplish to have an aesthetically pleasing feed. VSCO's filters and editing tools actually make them an easy process. If you have a favourite 'recipe' that

works well with your chosen theme you should save this recipe to edit images easily in the future. Tap on the third icon from the left on the toolbar, and then click on the plus icon. Your recipe is now saved. Next time you are editing an image which requires the same edit, with or without some minor changes, simply tap on the saved recipe and the effect will be applied immediately. This ultimately aids in faster and easier edits, allowing you to put out content that much faster.



DSCO is designed to allow users to take short videos and turn them into GIFs. You can create GIFs up to 2.5 seconds long, add a basic filter and then export this GIF to your gallery or even share



Save recipes on your favourite filters and tools on VSCO

it directly to your VSCO feed. To use DSCO, first launch the VSCO camera. You will see 'DSCO' next to the 'Photo' option. Press and hold the shooter button to capture a video that will be turned into a GIF. You will then be given an option to apply a basic preset which can be accessed by swiping through the list. The DSCO is now ready to share on your VSCO feed and will automatically be saved on to your camera roll.

Note: This feature is limited to iOS devices for now.